

东南康州中文学校之窗

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Speech Contest Announcement

SCCS' 8th Chinese Speech Contest will be held on Sunday, December 15, 2013, in East Lyme High School Auditorium from 10:00 AM to 1:00 PM. Although participation is not mandatory, we highly encourage our students to participate. Many past award winners carried their enthusiasm in Chinese learning on to becoming SCCS event hosts and hostesses, to earn perfect scores in Chinese SAT and AP, and to become student teachers at SCCS now!

You may choose a topic most familiar to you, or be creative! Surprise us with your language talent. Talk to your teachers, your parents, and your friends to get the best idea for your presentation. We are looking forward to seeing the best of you!



◆ We are proud to announce that SCCS has officially become a certifying organization for the President's Volunteer Service Award (PVSA). SCCS can now nominate the volunteers in our school and community, verify their eligibility, and distribute the President's Volunteer Service Awards to them. For more information about PVSA, please visit their

www.presidentialserviceawards.gov or contact us at: admin@ctscs.org.

- ◆ On Sept 21, SECCCS held an annual Mid-autumn festival. People enjoyed the beautiful moon, delicious foods, singing and dancing.
- ◆ Invited by the Waterford Public Schools, students and teachers from Shandong, China, visited the Shoreline and other local places. Some SCCS teachers, along with school leaders joined the get-together sponsored by Waterford Public High School.
- ◆ The first Chinese teaching forum of Connecticut Chinese schools, organized by the SCCS, was held at the Holliday Inn, New London, CT from 1 pm to 7 pm on September 28th. Four invited speakers, Ms. Lili Yang and Ms. Xiaohui Cao from SCCS, Ms. Lan Lin from South Connecticut Chinese School, and Ms. Haiyan Feng from Central Connecticut Chinese Academy, gave presentations at the forum. Over forty Chinese language teachers and school leaders from four Chinese schools attended the forum.
- ◆ On October 27th, a Halloween costume contest was held at ELHS cafeteria after school. Over twenty SCCS students participated in the contest. Thank Mr. Danny Lee from SECCCS for organizing the event, Mr. Xidong Feng, Shangtai Wang, Danny Lee, and James Zhu for serving as judges.

(Ms. Yinyu Tu)

Community News



Bits and Pieces from the First Chinese Teaching Forum of Connecticut Chinese Schools

Three challenges faced by overseas Chinese Schools:

1. The Chinese levels of students are highly variable;
2. The learning habits of students are highly individualized;
3. The ways of student's thinking are highly diverse.

We can't just continue to use the same teaching methodologies inherited from our own teachers in China.

New philosophies:

1. We need to keep the methodologies used in the overseas Chinese teaching as close as possible to those used in regular schools.
2. There is no good or bad differentiation among students. However, there are great differentiations in terms of types of talents, interests, personalities, etc. Various tools and means which are individualized to each student's interest, specific levels, and learning habits are needed.
3. The main purpose of Chinese school teaching is to nurture student's interest in learning Chinese and to stimulate student's own interest to become a lifetime learner (learning Chinese).

Many attendees and presenters agreed that it is very important to have "multiplicities", "interesting activities", and "mutual interactions" in the class. Six methods have been

shared: Clap Review, Vote with Your Feet, Fly Swap, Whisper, Drawing before Writing, and Sticky Notes. Teachers should selectively use various methods based on the specific situation in each classroom.



Forum Snap Shot

Multiplicity is also represented by the difference between the students from Chinese vs. non-Chinese origins. The experiences shared at the



Group Photo of the Forum



Halloween Custom Contest

forum include teaching in a simulated "language environment" for students of Chinese origin in order to utilize their advantages in listening and speaking, and "immersion" teaching for those with non-Chinese origin. All agreed that teachers have to use Chinese in classroom teaching.

Interesting and practical tools include doing activities, switching roles, and using multi-media in teaching. The homework can be creative, such as recording, interviewing, or making artistic work in Chinese.

PHOTOS OF CHINESE FORUM



Ms. Lan Lin — From South Connecticut Chinese School



Ms. Lili Yang— from SCCS



Ms. Xiaohui Cao— from SCCS



Teachers' Group Discussion



Ms. Haiyan Feng
From Central Connecticut Chinese School

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本刊祝全体读者感恩节快乐!

Chinese Writing and Pronunciation Contest

Has One's Ears Burning

- Not long ago, the Chinese Central TV held an event called Chinese writing and pronunciation contest for school age students in China. Public opinions are divided for this event. We recently obtained a series of blogs from friends in China. We re-publish the blogs here, so our teachers and parents can look at the event from various angles and hopefully will generate thoughts and analysis for teaching Chinese at SCCS and overseas.
- This event, which attracted more audiences than some popular shows did, is a testament of our enthusiasm to learn Chinese and inherit the culture. The biggest feeling after watching the contest is that we don't have to worry about the future of Chinese (language and culture).
- A blemish in an otherwise perfect event is that some characters used in the contest are rarely used and outdated. Some were documented in an ancient recipe book but nobody knows what they are referring to, and others only appeared in one ancient book but have never been used since. One should question the purpose of putting in so much effort to learn these outdated words. The 21st century is an information age. It is a good thing to hunger to learn, however one should use his time wisely.
- These rarely used characters only discourage one's interest in learning Chinese. Language has to evolve with the time. If we cherish the outmoded too much and take in the fresh not enough, we will make the Chinese (language) a thing of the past.
- Not every ancient character is outdated. Some are still lively words that, if used properly, will make one's speech or writing more elegant.
- Chinese language is definitely a marvel among languages of the world. The characters have beautiful shapes and are full of ex-

pressions. What I feel the most proud about the Chinese language is that it seems to have the ability to effortlessly and faithfully express the meaning of a foreign word with only the re-combination of existing and new characters.

- If a nation holds the view that its culture is so rich in history, therefore, that no character should be deleted or modified, it hinders its own advancement by cherishing the outmoded.
- If we want foreigners to learn Chinese, we have to make the characters easier for them to learn. One of the ways is to reduce the number of characters and increase the meanings (functions) of every character. One may define two to three thousands of commonly used characters, make these characters carry the majority of the meaning of all commonly used Chinese characters, and require the public to use these characters in all publications. Other characters can only be used in special occasions such as historical names, old poems, etc.
- In addition, we have to normalize the pronunciation of characters in relationship to their shapes and structures, so that anyone with a basic knowledge of Chinese can guess the pronunciation of any character.



Pronunciation: Biáng

(BiángBiáng Noodle: Noodle with traditional distinctive flavor in Shanxi, China)

